

1950, August 18

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by the
Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

CAPUCHIN FRANCISCAN
FATHERS

PAX ET BONUM

ST. FELIX FRIARY
HUNTINGTON, INDIANA

August 18th 1950

(seal)

Eles'd be God; in all His designs.

John Martin — Frater Don Bosco, o.f.m.cap. (at least in spirit and hope, I trust)

God bless you Frater Don Bosco. I hope this find things more promising with you and yours than seemed to be when you wrote me last week. The intentions you wrote about have been in my mind pretty much ever since reading your letter; and I hope in my poor prayers. No, I had not heard of your stepping out of the Clericat. I was sorry of course and disappointed; but do hope that the Holy Ghost — the divine Spirit guided you and that in the end it will turn to have been to your advantage and to the glory of God. Glad at all events, that the trouble was nothing more than physical; for even from the clean sports' columns like in the lives of the saints, we find innumerable examples where such difficulties only heightened appreciation for the hoped-for ideal and Goal. One of the great advantages of a study of the lives of the saints, is the supernatural courage that such studying tends so positively to foster. And at the same time appreciation for one's vocation; — appreciation — the natural foundation of gratitude which, in its turn, — "Gratitude, the very first and surest indication of intelligence." Hence the poet's happy dictum:

"The lives of all great men remind
us that we can make our lives sublime.

"And, parting leave behind us worthy
footsteps in the sans of time".
Footprints

Pope Pius XII; peerless and outstanding champion To-day of dogma, of morality, of peace among men and nations; stresses this virtue as man's first and gravest duty.

Lives of saints? ... In 1909 I had completely lost the hearing in my left ear and the same condition was rapidly threatening the other side. I had returned a certain Thursday-evening from the specialist with a throbbing ear-ache after a very painful treatment and very delicate and dangerous propositions. Five years before that, I had read the life of Sister Therese Martin, till then seemingly quite unknown, and had greatly profited thereby; happy in the communion of saints as I felt, on having met another heavenly little friend. I had felt from the first reading that she would be canonized. Well, in my anxiety that night I made a "mental proposition" to her that if she would help to save my hearing I'd read her life again. I was even then confident that she could help me and that being already in Heaven, she would.